

Bitcoin to help companies in Africa (currently Kenya, Nigeria, Tanzania, and Uganda) send and receive global payments.¹⁴

Ripple has been a popular startup for incumbents to work with, and some of them are creating projects that utilize its native asset, XRP. Incumbents such as Bank of America, RBC, Santander, BMO, CIBC, ATB Financial, and more use Ripple's blockchain-based technology to achieve faster and more secure financial transactions.¹⁵ If realized, these efforts could not only reward the companies that utilize Ripple but also potentially benefit Ripple's own cryptoasset, XRP, which can be used as a bridge currency to help settlements on the Ripple network.¹⁶

The innovative investor will want to monitor how cheaper money flows may create opportunities for new and existing businesses in emerging markets. Capital fuels the growth of industries, and if money moves more freely between citizens and businesses, that may induce a significant economic boom in developing markets. This, too, may warrant an investigation of which geographies stand to benefit the most, as many ETFs and mutual funds can be purchased for exposure to targeted geographies. Geographic diversification can benefit a portfolio when isolated macroeconomic dislocations strike.

Insurance and Blockchain Technology

Thus far, most insurance companies have opted to investigate DLT implementations and have not ventured far into the world of cryptoassets. Large consulting firms are competing to be viewed as thought leaders on how distributed ledger